

Novo Nordisk Fonden
Tuborg Havnevej 19
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Regarding application for New Exploratory Research and Discovery (NERD) Programme 2026

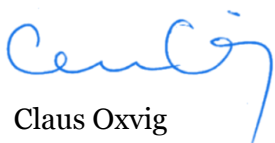
On behalf of the department, I hereby express my strong support for the application "*Mind the Drive: The Neurodevelopmental Cost of Policing Sex Chromosomes*" submitted by associate professor Kasper Munch.

We confirm that Kasper's current external grant portfolio does not exceed 4 million DKK per year (including possible overhead) in the year of commencing the project.

In the project proposed here, Kasper will apply computational methods and mathematical models of molecular evolution to address the process of meiotic drive, a general mechanism shaping genome evolution. Although meiotic drive has been observed in fungi, insects, and mammals, the field has been reluctant to apply the same mathematical logic to human evolution in the absence of empirical evidence. With this project, Kasper and his research team will test two hypotheses that link meiotic drive to the genetic basis of autism spectrum disorder. By linking the mathematical evolutionary models to an observable human phenotype the insights gained from this project will make it possible to formulate testable predictions that can be matched by empirical observations.

Based on the above, the department of Molecular Biology and Genetics is pleased to administer the grant in case of funding and to provide the required infrastructure, laboratory and office space within the existing framework. The enclosed budget has been approved by the department, and we agree to manage the potential grant according to this budget.

Yours sincerely,



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Head of Department

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